The Standard Bearer (Rembrandt, 1636)

Contents hide
(Top)
2022 acquisition by the Netherlands
Notable copies
See also
References

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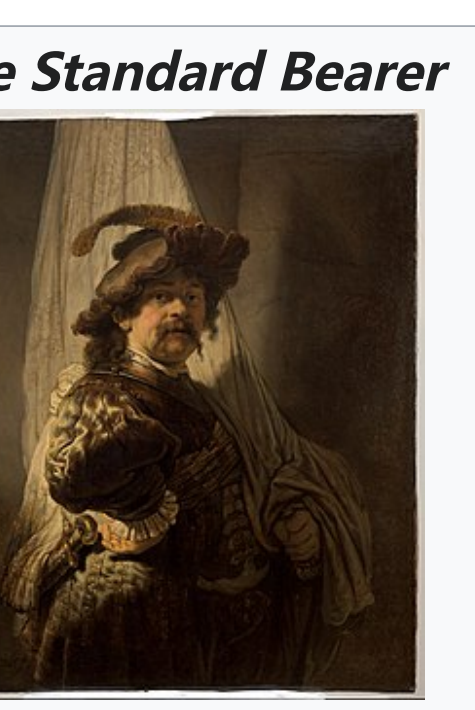
The Standard Bearer



De vaandeldrager

Artist	Rembrandt
Year	1636
Catalogue	Rembrandt Research Project, A Corpus of Rembrandt Paintings VI: #147
Medium	Oil on canvas
Dimensions	118.8 cm × 96.8 cm (46.8 in × 38.1 in)
Location	Rijksmuseum, Amsterdam

The Standard Bearer is a three-quarter-length self-portrait by Rembrandt formerly in the Paris collection of Elie de Rothschild, and purchased by the Rijksmuseum for 175 million euros with assistance from the Dutch state and Vereniging Rembrandt in 2021. It was painted on the occasion of the artist's move from Leiden to Amsterdam and is seen as an important early work that "shows Rembrandt's ambition to paint a group portrait for the Amsterdam militia, at the time the most valued commission a painter could be awarded."[1]

Rembrandt's flag bearer has several copies in oil, and later prints may be from such copies, but this painting nevertheless has a provenance reaching far into the 18th-century. It was documented as a self-portrait by Smith in 1836, who wrote:

> Rembrandt in the character of a Standard-Bearer. His portly countenance, which is seen in nearly a front view, denotes him to have been about fifty years of age; a large hat, turned up at the side, and decked with feathers, covers his head, and a steel cuirass shields his breast: the remainder of his habiliments are suitably rich and appropriate. One hand grasps the staff of an unfurled banner, and the other is placed on his side. This splendidly-coloured picture is engraved by Lause, and also by G. Haid. From the collection of Chevalier Verhulst, M. le Boeuf and M. Robit. It was afterwards in the collection of his Majesty George IV., who exchanged it with M. Lafontaine for other pictures.
>
> —Smith, 1836[2]

Cornelis Hofstede de Groot agreed with him in 1914, but stopped short of calling it a self-portrait. He wrote:

> 270 A STANDARD-BEARER. Sm. 201, and Suppl. 23; Bode 300; Dut. 148; Wb. 313; B.-HdG. 206.
>
> He stands in profile to the right, turning his face round and looking at the spectator. With his left hand he holds a large white banner on his shoulder; his right hand is on his hip. Over his brown curls he wears a slashed cap with a brown plume; his face is shaved, save for the long moustache. Over his yellowish-brown coat, trimmed with lace, he wears an iron gorget and a broad sash from which a sword hangs at his side. He has loose sleeves and a white collar and wrist-bands. Strong light from the left touches his back and his face and falls full on the banner. Life size, three-quarter length. The man has Rembrandt's features.
>
> Signed on the right at foot, "Rembrandt 163-" the last figure, now illegible, was probably a 5; canvas, 50 by 42 inches [1,300 mm × 1,100 mm].
>
> A copy is in the Cassel Gallery, 1903 catalogue, No. 251 (Wb. 53); it has been there since the 1749 inventory, and was etched by N. Mossoloff.
>
> Another copy is in the collection of the late P. A. B. Widener, Philadelphia, 1908 catalogue, No. 242. Other copies were in the
>
> Sales. J. F. Wolschot, Antwerp, September 1, 1817, No. 12.
>
> Duke of Buckingham, Stowe, August 15, 1848, No. 415 (£54 : 12s., Wakeford Attree).
>
> Etched by P. Louw, J. F. Clerck, G. Haid.
>
> Mentioned by Vosmaer, pp. 340, 554; by Bode, p. 597; by Dutuit, p. 52; [by Michel, pp. 166-7, 169, 436].
>
> Exhibited at the British Institution, London, 1819, No. 59, and 1836, No. 34.
>
> Sales. L. van Heemskerk, Leyden, September 2, 1771, No. I (61 florins, Delfos); to judge from the price, this was one of the copies. G. F. J. de Verhulst, Brussels, August 16, 1779, No - 8o (354 florins or, according to other authorities, 1290 francs, Fouquet). Le Boeuf, Paris, 1782 (5300 francs). Robit, Paris, May 21, 1801, No. 117 of Bryan's catalogue (3095 francs, Lafontaine).
>
> In the collection of George IV., King of England, who exchanged it with Lafontaine for other pictures.
>
> In the possession of the London dealer Lafontaine. In the collection of Sir Simon H. Clarke, London.
>
> In the collection of Lady Clarke, Oak Hill, 1836 (Sm., who valued it at 525).
>
> Sale. Sir Simon Clarke, Bart., London, May 8, 1840 (840, Baron James de Rothschild, Paris).
>
> In the collection of Baron Henry de Rothschild, Paris.
>
> —Hofstede de Groot, 1914[3]

2022 acquisition by the Netherlands [edit]

In 2019 the painting has been classified as a national treasure of France, so an export bar was in place for 30 months while the Louvre tried to raise funds to buy the painting.[4] The museum was unable to do so and waived its right of first refusal for purchase. In December 2021, the Dutch state announced its intention to buy the work for the national collection.[5]

As result, the Rothschild family sold the painting to the Netherlands for €175 million in 2022. The Dutch government paid €150 million, while the Rembrandt Association and the Rijksmuseum contributed a total of €25 million. It was bought from the Rothschild family, who had owned it since 1844,[6] via a trust located in the tax haven of the Cook Islands.[7] *The Standard Bearer* was sent to tour every province in the Netherlands before going on display at the Rijksmuseum's Gallery of Honour.[8] It was acquired during the COVID-19 pandemic amid media coverage of failing income for the Netherlands' cultural sector. The painting had previously been shown at the Rijksmuseum in 2019 and had attracted the museum's interest once France agreed to let the painting leave the country.[6]

The painting toured the Netherlands in 2022 and 2023.[9]

Notable copies [edit]

Version in Kassel[10]

Copy of the Kassel copy, damaged[11]

Version in Widener collection[12]

Version by Ferdinand Bol[13]

Version in Philipps House[14]

Mezzotint by Pieter Louw

Mezzotint by Johann Peter Pichler

See also [edit]

- List of most expensive paintings
- List of paintings by Rembrandt

References [edit]

1. ^ Rijksmuseum (8 December 2021). "The Dutch State today announced its intention to purchase Rembrandt's The Standard Bearer (1636) for the national collection". *Rijksmuseum*. Retrieved 9 December 2021.
2. ^ Entry 201 for "*Rembrandt in the Character of a Standard Bearer*" in Smith, 1836
3. ^ Entry 270 for "*A Standard-Bearer*" in Hofstede de Groot, 1914
4. ^ "Art Industry News: The Louvre Must Race to Buy a Rembrandt Masterpiece Before It Leaves France Forever + Other Stories". *Artnet News*. 2019-04-24. Retrieved 2022-05-07.
5. ^ Goldstein, Caroline (2022-01-19). "The Netherlands Makes a Controversial Decision to Buy a Prized Rembrandt for a Whopping $198 Million". *Artnet News*. Retrieved 2022-05-07.
6. ^ *a* *b* "Netherlands to buy Rembrandt Standard Bearer self-portrait". *BBC News*. 8 December 2021.
7. ^ "Rothschild family selling 'The Standard Bearer' through company link to SVG". *St Vincent Times*. St Vincent Times. Retrieved 21 January 2022.
8. ^ Lee Cheshire (18 January 2022). "Dutch government agrees to buy Rembrandt painting for €175m—despite connections to tax havens". *The Art Newspaper*.
9. ^ Fernández, G. (2022-04-30). "The $200 million Rembrandt begins its tour of the Netherlands". *theartwolf*. Retrieved 2022-05-07.
10. ^ Der Fahnenträger, GK 251, circa 1636, acquired in 1755 by Wilhelm VIII. from General von Donop
11. ^ Menz, Martin. "Fahnenträger (Kopie nach Rembrandt)". *Museumslandschaft Hessen Kassel (MHK)* (in German). Retrieved 2024-09-22.
12. ^ The Standard Bearer 38¾ in × 28⅜ in (980 mm × 720 mm), Estimate: $400,000-600,000, lot offered in Old Masters Part I on 19 April 2019 at Christie' s in New York
13. ^ Drawing by Ferdinand Bol after Rembrandt, circa 1636, Richard Payne Knight bequest, British Museum
14. ^ The Standard Bearer, National Trust, Philipps House, Dinton, gift from Bertram Philipps, 1943 in Art UK

V • T • E **Rembrandt** [hide]

Lists of drawings, etchings, paintings, prints, self-portraits

Paintings	*The Senses* (1624–25) • *The Stoning of Saint Stephen* (1625) • *Suffer little children to come unto me* (1620s) • *History Painting* (1626) • *Balaam and the Ass* (1626) • *The Baptism of the Eunuch* (1626) • *Bust of a Man Wearing a Gorget and Plumed Beret* (1626) • *Tobit and Anna with the Kid* (c. 1626) • *The Flight into Egypt* (1627) • *The Parable of the Rich Fool* (1627) • *The Artist in his Studio* (1628) • *Samson and Delilah* (1629–30) • *Jeremiah Lamenting the Destruction of Jerusalem* (1630) • *Anna and the Blind Tobit* (c. 1630) • *The Raising of Lazarus* (c. 1630–1632) • *Andromeda Chained to the Rocks* (1631) • *The Anatomy Lesson of Dr. Nicolaes Tulp* (1631) • *Christ with a Staff* (1631) • *Christ on the Cross* (1631) • *Old Man with a Gold Chain* (c. 1631) • *Philosopher in Meditation* (1632) • *The Abduction of Europa* (1632) • *Adoration of the Magi* (1632–1633) • *The Shipbuilder and his Wife* (1633) • *The Storm on the Sea of Galilee* (1633) 2 • *A Lady and Gentleman in Black* (1633) • *Raising of the Cross* (1633) • *Descent from the Cross* (1633) • *Vision of Zacharias in the Temple* (1633) • *Diana Bathing with her Nymphs with Actaeon and Callisto* (1634) • *Flora* (1634) • *Judith at the Banquet of Holofernes* (1634) • *Descent from the Cross* (1634) • *Belshazzar's Feast* (1635) • *Minerva* (1635) • *The Prodigal Son in the Brothel* (c. 1635) • *Raising of the Cross (study)* (c. 1635) • *The Rape of Ganymede* (1635) • *The Entombment of Christ* (1635) • *Samson Threatening His Father-In-Law* (1635) • ***The Standard Bearer*** (1636) • *Danaë* (1636) • *The Blinding of Samson* (1636) • *Landscape with Arched Bridge* (c. 1636-1637) • *The Preacher Eleazar Swalmius* (1637) • *The Archangel Raphael Leaving Tobias' Family* (1637) • *The Stone Bridge* (1637) • *The Wedding Feast of Samson* (1638) • *Landscape with the Good Samaritan* (1638) • *Still Life with Peacocks* (c. 1639) • *The Girl in a Picture Frame* (1641) • *The Scholar at the Lectern* (1641) • *The Night Watch* (1642) • *Concord of the State* (1642) • *David and Jonathan* (1642) • *Boaz* and *Ruth* (1643) • *The Woman Taken in Adultery* (1644) • *Joseph's Dream* (1645) • *Holy Family with Angels* (1645) • *The Mill* (1645–1648) • *Abraham Serving the Three Angels* (1646) • *Susanna and the Elders* (1647) • *Head of Christ* (1648) • *The Kitchen Maid* (1651) • *Descent from the Cross* (1650–1652) • *Saul and David* (c. 1652) 1 • *Aristotle with a Bust of Homer* (1653) • *A Woman Bathing in a Stream* (1654) • *Bathsheba at Her Bath* (1654) • *The Polish Rider* (1655) 1 • *Slaughtered Ox* (1655) • *Pallas Athena* (c. 1655) • *The Anatomy Lesson of Dr. Deijman* (1656) • *Jacob Blessing the Sons of Joseph* (1656) • *Courtesan at her Mirror* (1657) • *Saint Bartholomew* (1657) • *Moses Breaking the Tablets of the Law* (1659) • *Ahasuerus and Haman at the Feast of Esther* (1660) • *The Denial of Saint Peter* (1660) • *Titus as a Monk* (1660) • *The Conspiracy of Claudius Civilis* (1661) • *Saint Matthew and the Angel* (1661) • *Syndics of the Drapers' Guild* (1662) • *Homer Dictating his Verses* (1663) • *The Jewish Bride* (1664) • *Lucretia* (1664) 1 • *David and Uriah* (c. 1665) • *Young Woman with a Lapdog* (1665) • *Lucretia* (1666) • *The Return of the Prodigal Son* (1662–1669) • *Simeon in the Temple* (c. 1669) • *Landscape with a Castle*
Portraits	*Portrait of Nicolaes Ruts* (1631) • *Portrait of a Man* (1632) • *Portrait of a Woman* (1632) • *Portrait of Jacob de Gheyn III* (1632) • *Portrait of a 62-year-old Woman* (1632) • *Portrait of a Man Rising from His Chair* (1633) • *Portrait of a Young Woman with a Fan* (1633) • *Oval Portrait of a Woman* (1633) • *Portrait of a Woman Wearing a Gold Chain* (1634) • *Pendant portraits of Maerten Soolmans and Oopjen Coppit* (1634) • *Portrait of Petronella Buys* (1635) • *A Polish Nobleman* (1637) • *Portrait of Maria Trip* (1639) • *Portrait of Jan Six* (1654) • *Portrait of Floris Soop* (1654) • *Portrait of Hendrickje Stoffels* (1654–1656) • *Portrait of Catharina Hooghsaet* (1657) • *Portrait of a Man* (1657) • *Portrait of a Man with Arms Akimbo* (1658) • *Portrait of a Young Man in an Armchair* (1660) • *Portrait of Dirck van Os* (c. 1662) • *Portrait of Gerard de Lairesse* (1665–1667)
Self-portraits	*Self-Portrait with Dishevelled Hair* (1628) • *Rembrandt Laughing* (1628) • *Self-Portrait* (1629) • *Self-Portrait in a Gorget* (c.1629) • *Portrait of a Young Man with a Golden Chain* (1635) (*disputed*) • *Self-Portrait Wearing a White Feathered Bonnet* (1635) • *Self-Portrait with an Architectural Background* (c. 1639) • *Self-Portrait at the Age of 34* (1640) • *Self-Portrait* (1652) • *Self-Portrait in a Black Beret and Gold Chain* (1654) • *Self-Portrait* (1658) • *Self-Portrait with Beret and Turned-Up Collar* (1659) • *Self-Portrait* (1660) • *Self-Portrait as the Apostle Paul* (1662) • *Self-Portrait as Zeuxis Laughing* (1662) • *Self-Portrait with Two Circles* (1665–1669) • *Self-Portrait* (c. 1669) • *Self-Portrait at the Age of 63* (1669)
Drawings and prints (including etchings)	*Joseph and Potiphar's Wife* (1634) • *Bearded Old Man* (1634) • *River with Trees* (1634) • *The Artist and his Model* (1639) • *The Death of the Virgin* (1639) • *The Mill* (1641) • *The Three Trees* (1643) • *The State Bed* (1646) • *Portrait of Jan Six* (1647) • *Hundred Guilder Print* (1647–1649) • *Conus Marmoreus* (1650) • *Goldweigher's Field* (1651) • *Doctor Fautrieus* (1652) • *Descent from the Cross by Torchlight* (1652) • *The Three Crosses* (1653) • *The Virgin and Child with a Cat* (1654) • *Christ Presented to the People* (1655) • Mughal drawings
Collections	Rembrandt House Museum • Rembrandt in Southern California
Rembrandt studies	Connoisseurs and scholars • Rembrandt Research Project • Rembrandt catalogues raisonnés (1908 • 1935 • 1968 • 1986)
Related people	Pupils • Saskia van Uylenburgh (wife, model) • Titus van Rijn (son, model) • Geertje Dircx (mistress, model) • Hendrickje Stoffels (mistress, model) • Jacob Isaacsz. van Swanenburg (teacher) • Pieter Lastman (teacher) • Jan Lievens (colleague and friend) • Hendrick van Uylenburgh (art dealer, patron) • Jan Six (art collector, patron) • Thomas Kaplan (art collector)
Works about Rembrandt	Cultural depictions of Rembrandt • *Rembrandt's Daughter* (1827 painting) • *The Tragedy of a Great* (1920 film) • *Rembrandt* (1936 film) • *Rembrandt* (1940 film) • *Rembrandt* (1942 film) • *Rembrandt: A Self-Portrait* (1954 documentary film) • *Rembrandt fecit 1669* (1977 film) • *The Anatomy Lesson* (1995 novel) • *Rembrandt* (1999 film) • *Stealing Rembrandt* (2003 film) • *Nightwatching* (2007 film) • *I Am Rembrandt's Daughter* (2008 novel)
Namesakes	Rembrandt, Iowa • Rembrandtplein • Rembrandtpark • Rembrandt (crater) • *Rembrandt* (train) • Vereniging Rembrandt (foundation)

1 Contested • 2 Stolen in 1990

Authority control databases RKD ID

Categories: Portraits by Rembrandt | 2021 in the Netherlands | 1636 paintings | Paintings in the Rijksmuseum

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